



Soon the Media Center made its way from PCs to tablets

work with HDTV displays and multi-touch. Media Center didn't stand alone, of course. Microsoft pushed this interface to mobile devices as well, first via its short-lived Portable Media Center platform and then with the "Origami" interfaces it created for the Ultra-Mobile PC. Both of these products were failures from a sales perspective, but they provided Microsoft with valuable experience in melding very visual user interfaces and touch capabilities into highly portable form factors.

And then came Zune. Microsoft's answer to the iPod hasn't exactly set the world on fire, but again, by iterating this portable media platform over four generations of devices, culminating with the Zune HD in late 2009, Microsoft gained still more experience. And its work on the Zune HD and the PC



Microsoft's answer to iPod

software employed by Zune users to synchronise with PC-based digital media content, would lead directly to the Windows Phone platform. This platform has many components, and as you'll discover, Windows Phone users, like Zune HD users, also use the Zune PC software to synchronise PC-based music, video and photos to their devices. But the single biggest influence that the Zune platform has on Windows Phone, of course, is the user interface (or "user experience"). And on Windows Phone, this highly evolved UI is now called "Metro". 